

Discipleship attitude

Looking into the life of apostle and a disciple of Jesus, Peter

Mathew 4:18-22 is the account of the calling of Peter and his brother Andrew both of whom were originally fisher men. Jesus said to them “come follow me and I will make you into fishers of men”.

With a lot of ease and quick conviction they left their nets and boats and the lake too and came along with Jesus. Salvation is always for such people who are easy to decide to follow Christ at the very moment they hear the Gospel. In **Luke 9:59-62** Jesus implies that anyone who tries to think twice on whether or not to receive the gospel is not worth the value it carries

Fishing on men must have been something very unfamiliar with Peter but most interesting is how he easily he blended with the Lord and did not get stopped by the fact that he did not know about this new thing

He was eager to learn this new profession and his association with Jesus from this moment on made he began to understand what Jesus meant. Jesus was doing great things everywhere they went and taught with unmatched wisdom

- Healing the sick
- Restoring the blind
- Made the dumb to speak again
- Cast out demons from the possessed
- Forgave sins
- Raised the dead back to life

With time Peter started to believe that fishing men was all that Jesus was doing. Now because Jesus had said to him “follow after me and I will make you into a fisher of men”, He developed a deep desire of being like Jesus

He tried in his own knowledge, understanding and strength, copying Jesus and hoping one day he may surprise his master with a miracle, but all he did in vain. For instance in **Mathew 17:14-20** is the account of a demon possessed boy who was brought by his parents to Jesus for deliverance. But finding Jesus too busy with other people, the disciple tried to cast out the demon even without the knowledge of Jesus but in vain. He called the support of his brother and others but they still could not manifest God’s power. From this moment Peter thought there must be something secret that their master has that helps to do great things than he had observed. Later in the day Peter led them to Jesus asking Him why they could not cast out the demon. He wanted to perfect his practising into being like Jesus

In **Luke 11:1-5** Peter led a group of disciples to Jesus asking Him to teach them how to pray. Now Peter had grown tired of praying with no answer coming forth. He had seen Jesus pray from God and multiplied small amounts of food to plenty. He saw and heard Him pray for Lazarus to wake up from the dead

The truth was that Peter loved Jesus **John 21:15-17** (after Jesus asked Peter if he loved Him a third time, Peter felt bad that Jesus was acting as if He hadn’t known that he loved Him)

He wanted to be like Jesus **Mathew 14:27-29** (he said to Jesus, “may I walk on the waters like you? Jesus said, yes, come”). He always wanted to be with Him and

experience like Him **Luke 22:54** (when Jesus was arrested and taken to the chief priest, Peter was the only disciple who followed Jesus to the court room)

He was in the front line of defence for Jesus and wouldn’t allow anything bad to happen on Him. When Jesus told them that now the time has come when He must go back to Jerusalem where He will be arrested and crucified as per the scripture, Peter for the love of his master said to Him such a thing would not happen to Him as he watched. He promised to use his sword in the defense of his Lord

All this time Jesus knew everything about Peter and in few occasions He commented on it. In **John 21:15-17** Jesus implies to Peter that he (Jesus) knew that he (Peter) loved Him and a time was coming when he (peter) was going to take His (Jesus) place in discipleship

In **Luke 22:32** Jesus looked at Peter and said to him “I pray for you that the desire that you have had all this long is fulfilled at God’s time and it does not fail”

A true desire to be like Jesus has got a constructive jealousy in it. When Peter felt that his desire to be like Jesus was not coming to be, he felt discouraged, wasted and wrecked. He decided to go back and resume the work he knew before encountering Jesus. Probably he felt that he did not have the qualifications to fish out men like Jesus. He decided to go back to the lake. Interesting, when he said to the other disciples that he was retiring from following Jesus and was going back to the lake, other six disciples, including Nathaniel of Cana went with him **John 21:3**

On this particular day, all night fishing was in vain, nothing caught not even a fingerling. The sea did not know them. These men were now dangerous strangers and the gates could not be opened for them. This is the kind of life backsliders of spiritual kingdoms go through.

It is because when we are called to the kingdom and make deliberate choice to accept the call, a special mark (seal or symbol) is burnt on you to identify you and to separate you **Revelation 7:1-3** and **2 Timothy 2:19**

In the next morning they were tired, discouraged, hungry, disappointed and hungry. They asked themselves questions and no one was there to provide answers. It felt like it had been wrong all long to have followed Jesus. One time Peter asked Jesus, "What is there for us who left everything and followed you and have always been faithful to you?"

Jesus knew at this time that the wait had been long especially for Peter. He woke up in the morning and knowing where they were He went to them and commanded the sea to release the fortunes of catch for His men. They harvested in the morning plenty in triple excess of how much they wanted

Now it was the time for Jesus to open up to them of what must happen on Him for their dreams to come true **Matthew 16:21**. He further told them to prepare to wait in Jerusalem for the divine enabling of the Holy Ghost and they did indeed gather in Jerusalem after Jesus was arrested and crucified. After ten days of waiting in the upper chamber in one of buildings in the city, the Holy Spirit of God visited them **Acts 1:4-8** and anointed them for the ministry

The disciples by the enabling power of the Spirit of God now started to replicate Jesus in power and faith. For instance, Peter immediately started his gospel ministry and went on teaching in the towns of Jerusalem. In his first sermon he converted over 3000 people to become the followers of Christ **Acts 2:41**

A week later, Peter converted over 5000 people, **Acts 4:4** and there on, he became a true image of his master. He replicated Jesus in many dimensions. In **Acts 5:15-16** we meet a different Peter whose shadow has the power to heal and cast out demonic spirits to whoever it fell

Be patient and continue desiring to do great in the ministry. God has an appointment with you along the way and in His own time your journey of the ministry will take a dramatic change when God will eventually use you for His glory.

It started slow for Paul **Acts 9:20-21** (preaching in the synagogues in Damascus with no signs or wonders and people getting amazed of him). In **Acts 9:22** says that Paul without wearing out continued to from strength to strength. The Jews in Damascus waited for him to faint and go back to persecuting Christians in vain **verse 23** and when this did not happen they took counsel to kill him **verse 24**

Now the disciples helped him escape back to Jerusalem where he was helped by Barnabas to join with the apostles including Peter and his ministry went on increasing in power and strength. In **Acts 14:8-10**, came the first sign and wonders (miracle) when he commanded the healing of a crippled man and it was so

In **Acts 17:6** in Thessalonica people reported of a man who have come in the city and who had been turning the world upside down with the gospel. These men were Paul and Silas and Barnabas.

END

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